



THE STRANGE CASE OF DR JEKYLL AND MR HYDE

A Tale of Two Natures



ROBERT LOUIS STEVENSON

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Chapter One — The Door in the Fog

Mr. Utterson the lawyer was a man of rugged countenance, seldom lit by a smile, and it was this very steadiness that made his account of the door so unsettling to those who heard it.

It stood windowless in a otherwise handsome street, its paint blistered and stained, as though the building behind it had turned its back on the respectable façade it once wore.

"I make it a rule," he told his cousin, folding his hands, "to ask no questions when I dislike the answer I expect. But this door I cannot stop asking about."

Chapter Two — A Visit at Midnight

The knock came well after the household had gone to bed, three raps, unhurried, as though the caller knew exactly how long patience could be made to last.

When the door was opened the figure on the step was slight, almost boyish, and yet something in his stillness emptied the hallway of its usual warmth.

He did not give his name. He did not need to; the doctor upstairs had already gone very pale at the sound of his voice through the floor.